Jacques Groenewald

HEAD OF DIGITAL MARKETING

Paid Media, Performance Marketing, Marketing Operations and Analytics | B2B and eCommerce

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PROFILE

Digital marketing leader: 18 years in commercial roles, 11 of them leading digital. I run the channel mix and hold it to revenue: paid search and social, LinkedIn, SEO, email, conversion and tracking. For three years I **ran digital marketing for Ensinger UK**, a £80M+ manufacturer, across three brands as fractional Head of Digital Marketing, reporting to the MD. Before that I managed **Microsoft's MSN and Skype ad portfolio for Africa and the Middle East ($1.5M a month)** and ran an agency team of 10 that managed **$1M in Google and Meta ad spend** across 40+ client accounts. I judge channels on contribution margin and store-measured revenue, not platform-reported numbers, and build the fix myself. I am winding down my consultancy to give one full-time remote role my full attention.

KEY RESULTS

- **Cost per lead cut 77%** (£69 to £16) on LinkedIn for Ensinger UK, with 43 leads in 30 days.
- **Contact actions up 53%** for Ensinger UK through LinkedIn and Google Search; LinkedIn video **CTR from 1.09% to 2.0%** and cost per result from £2.50 to £1.30.
- **3.6x blended ROAS** in an owned brand's record month after rebuilding its Meta account, measured against store revenue rather than the 2.05x the platform reported.
- **550+ registrations and 300 attendees** for Outbound Investment Group's investor events in China, New York and South Africa.
- **Lead response for a travel franchise:** every lead answered in **under a minute** and quote preparation cut from an hour to **2 minutes**; 230 enquiries became 219 quotes (95%) and **$19,500 in bookings** in 30 days.

EXPERIENCE

FRACTIONAL HEAD OF DIGITAL MARKETING

Jun 2022 - Nov 2025

Ensinger UK, via JCE Media | Remote | Engineering plastics manufacturer, £80M+ sales, three brands

Reported to the MD and owned the digital plan and channel mix for Ensinger, Elekem and Insulbar, including the annual plan and report.

- Cut LinkedIn **cost per lead 77%** (£69 to £16) and nearly doubled video **CTR (1.09% to 2.0%)**.
- Lifted **contact actions 53%** across LinkedIn and Google Search.
- Built ABM outbound plus GA4 and Tag Manager tracking, then **handed a working function in-house** in Nov 2025.

FRACTIONAL HEAD OF MARKETING

Jun 2022 - Mar 2025

Club 720 and Your Housing Resource, via JCE Media | Remote | US homeownership platform

- Led digital across paid search and social, email, webinars and partners: **1,717 active users and 69 home-buyer applications** in 30 days.

FOUNDER AND GROWTH ADVISOR

Apr 2020 - Present

JCE Media, Johannesburg | Digital growth advisory

Advised the **CEOs and MDs of 25+ companies** in the UK, US and South Africa on go-to-market, including AeroCRS, WorldTicket, Dynamic Language, Ensinger and Club 720; two became the multi-year roles above. Core team of an operations lead and a sales partner, plus specialist contractors.

- **Paid media** across Google, Meta and LinkedIn for B2B and eCommerce clients, with creative testing and tracking rebuilt in GA4 and Tag Manager; SaaS outbound for AeroCRS reached a **60% reply rate**, 54% of replies booking a demo.
- **SEO:** rescued an eCommerce client's organic search after a site migration, mapping and verifying **590 redirects** covering 65.6% of revenue-bearing URLs.
- **CRM, email and lifecycle** in GoHighLevel, HubSpot, Pipedrive and Klaviyo, including a 22-email nurture for a six-location US salon group and, for Dynamic Language, a Pipedrive build that lifted **MQL to SQL conversion 35%**.
- **Demand generation: 550+ registrations** for investor events in China, New York and South Africa; **949 leads in 60 days at $4.78**.
- **Diagnosis:** a cohort analysis showed new-customer repeat rate falling from **38.7% to 12.3%**, which moved the client's relaunch from acquisition to retention.

FOUNDER

Feb 2025 - Present

ReviewTap and MyForeverBaby (own eCommerce brands), Johannesburg

Built two brands from zero to **$55,000+ in sales each**, owning P&L, pricing, paid acquisition and CRM.

- **3.6x blended ROAS** measured on store revenue, where the platform reported 2.05x; a controlled audit found simple ads bought customers **23% cheaper** than automated ones.
- Ran Google Search and AI-generated video ad production alongside Meta.

FOUNDER-DIRECTOR

Jan 2015 - Mar 2020

Duel Digital, Johannesburg | Digital marketing agency (pivoted to consultancy as JCE Media in 2020)

Built and led an in-house agency team of 10 (four salespeople, a designer, a developer, a media buyer, a social media manager and an executive assistant), hired every role myself, designed the sales comp plans and set the team's SLAs. We ran marketing for 40+ SMB accounts, managed **$1M in Google and Meta ad spend** across them, built **400+ websites** and ran in-store activations and competitions.

PORTFOLIO MANAGER, MICROSOFT MSN AND SKYPE

Jan 2012 - Dec 2014

Mediamark (media sales house) | Africa and Middle East

- Managed Microsoft's MSN and Skype advertising portfolio for Africa and the Middle East, **worth $1.5M a month**, as commercial lead for advertisers and their agencies; grew **net revenue retention from existing clients year on year**.
- Sold and managed digital campaigns for Vodacom, Unilever, Standard Bank, Absa, OUTsurance and 1st for Women through Omnicom and GroupM, including the **Vodacom Durban July ($300,000+)**.
- Ran cross-platform campaigns that extended to radio (Gagasi FM, Jacaranda FM, East Coast Radio), and was part of the launch of **Adfu**, Mediamark's programmatic media platform.
- Won the Hard Drive Award for top performer **five months in a row**.

SALES MANAGER

Jan 2009 - Dec 2011

Planet Fitness, Craighall and Rosebank, Johannesburg

- Hired, trained and led sales teams of up to 20 consultants across two clubs, with territory planning and forecasting; both clubs ranked among the **top 5 clubs in the country**.

SKILLS

DIGITAL MARKETING:	digital strategy and budgets, paid search and paid social (Google, Meta, LinkedIn), programmatic, A/B and creative testing, SEO and site migrations, content and social, email and lifecycle, CRO and landing pages, ABM and outbound, GA4 and conversion tracking, attribution, reporting and dashboards, agency and team leadership.
PLATFORMS:	Google Ads, Meta Ads, LinkedIn Ads, Google Analytics 4, Google Tag Manager, Search Console, Microsoft Clarity, HubSpot, Salesforce (reporting data), Pipedrive, GoHighLevel, Klaviyo, Lemlist, Shopify, WordPress and WooCommerce.
TOOLS:	Make.com, Zapier, n8n, Claude Code and AI agents, AI image and video generation, Python for data work; Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint and Power BI (advanced).

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BCom Management and Economics (incomplete: two modules outstanding, re-enrolling 2027), Central University of Technology.

Certifications (2026): HubSpot Revenue Operations; HubSpot Digital Marketing; OpenAI Academy (AI Foundations, AI Leadership, Agentic Systems, AI Application Performance); Anthropic Claude Academy (AI Fluency, Claude Enterprise, Human-Agent Teams).

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